

What Does It Cost to Manufacture a \$19 Wool Sweater?

A line-by-line B2B cost model for European fashion brands sourcing fine gauge knitwear and private label wool sweaters.

100% Wool · 2/26Nm · 12GG · 350g

500 pieces · 5 colours · Special wash and finishing

FOR OVERSEAS APPAREL BUYERS

Executive Summary

This white paper opens the cost structure of one defined product: a factory-priced USD 19 pure wool sweater.

The model uses confirmed inputs from the source article: 100% wool yarn at RMB 230/kg, 2/26Nm yarn count, 12GG knitting, 350g finished weight, 500 pieces split across five colours, and a softening plus shrink-control finish.

\$16.41

Estimated production cost

\$2.59

Factory gross profit

73.6%

Cost represented by yarn

Three takeaways

1. The largest cost is the 100% wool yarn, not factory labour or margin.
2. Five colours of 100 pieces are less efficient than one colour of 500 pieces.
3. A USD 15 quotation cannot support the same specification without a loss or a documented change.

Source boundary: the original article is about pure wool, not mohair. Mohair knitwear, brushed cashmere, luxury wool yarn and other fibre programs require new yarn prices, loss assumptions, brushing tests and separate quotations.

Source: [Original YouTricot cost breakdown](#)

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Official website: access current knitwear OEM resources, company information and contact channels at

www.youtricot.com

Document methodology

All numeric production inputs are taken from the source article. Where the requested SlideShare structure requires information not stated in the source, the document labels it as scope-dependent or to be confirmed.

DEFINED COSTING SCENARIO

Product Parameters and Costing Scope

Parameter	Confirmed input	Commercial implication
Fibre composition	100% wool	Material cost dominates the quotation.
Yarn count	2/26Nm	Requires compatibility testing with the target density.
Yarn purchase price	RMB 230/kg	Case input, not a universal market price.
Knitting gauge	12GG	Fine gauge knitwear with controlled tension and density.
Finished weight	350g	Measured product weight used for yarn costing.
Order	500 pieces	Commercial small-to-medium production case.
Colour split	5 colours × 100 pieces	Five separate setup, tracking and wash batches.
Wet processing	Softening + shrink control	Must be approved on the finished sample.
Factory price	USD 19/piece	Model selling price before international freight.
Model exchange rate	USD 1 = RMB 7.20	Costing assumption, not a live FX quote.

$350g \times 1.08 \text{ production allowance} = 378g \text{ costed yarn per garment}$

The product model assumes a basic crew-neck silhouette without intarsia, jacquard, embroidery, zippers or other labour-intensive details.

Re-cost required: mohair knitwear, high-end wool yarn, brushed cashmere, custom-dyed yarn, complex patterns and European knitwear OEM programmes with buyer-specific testing cannot inherit this USD 19 price automatically.

For production capability and service context, visit [YouTricot - custom knitwear manufacturer](#).

MATERIAL DRIVES COST

Yarn Composition and Material Logic

The costed yarn is 378g per garment, not the 350g finished weight.

Why an allowance is needed

- Machine setup and tension adjustment
- Trial and waste panels
- Yarn ends and panel repair
- Five-colour changes
- Damaged pieces
- Washing-related weight variation

Reproducible calculation

$$0.350\text{kg} \times 1.08 \times \text{RMB } 230/\text{kg} = \text{RMB } 86.94$$

$$\text{RMB } 86.94 \div 7.20 = \text{USD } 12.08$$

$$378\text{g} \times 500 \text{ pieces} = 189\text{kg}$$

What the 8% means

The 8% allowance is a commercial production allowance covering setup, irregular loss and material risk. It is not a guarantee that exactly 8% will become physical waste. Actual usage should be checked after sampling and size grading.

Certified and premium yarn

RWS wool, traceable high-end wool yarn or OEKO-TEX-compliant components may carry different purchasing and documentation costs. Certification must be verified for the specific yarn and transaction.

Mohair and brushed fibres

Mohair knitwear requires a separate blend ratio, yarn price, shedding assessment and brushing or raising process. No mohair percentage or price appears in the source article; those fields remain **to be confirmed** for a future programme.

FROM YARN TO PACKED GARMENT

12GG Production and Finishing Process

1. Programming and knitting

12GG is fine gauge knitwear. The allocation covers computerized flat-knitting time, basic programming, setup, operator labour, electricity, panel inspection and minor repair.

2. Linking and sewing

Shoulder linking, sleeve attachment, side seams, neck trim and loose-yarn finishing convert panels into a wearable garment.

3. Special washing

Softening, shrink-control and hand-feel adjustment influence dimensions, stitch appearance, colour and final touch.

4. Finishing

Controlled drying, steaming, shaping, measurement correction, thread trimming, surface cleaning, pressing and folding affect retail presentation.

5. Trims and packing

A basic private label package may include neck label, size label, care label, hangtag, spare yarn, tissue, polybag and carton allocation.

6. Knitwear quality control

Routine checks cover yarn lot, measurements, linking, surface defects, colour consistency, weight, labels and packing.

Important: shrink-control treatment does not automatically make wool machine washable. The final care claim must reflect the actual yarn, treatment and garment test results.

Testing references: [ISO 5077 dimensional change](#) · [ISO 12945-3 pilling](#) · [OEKO-TEX STANDARD 100](#)

LINE-BY-LINE TRANSPARENCY

Complete USD 19 Cost Breakdown

Cost item	RMB	USD	Share
Wool yarn incl. 8% allowance	86.94	12.08	73.6%
12GG knitting	6.50	0.90	5.5%
Linking and sewing	4.20	0.58	3.6%
Special washing	5.50	0.76	4.7%
Finishing and pressing	3.20	0.44	2.7%
Trims and packaging	2.80	0.39	2.4%
Quality control	1.50	0.21	1.3%
Equipment and energy	1.80	0.25	1.5%
Production management	3.20	0.44	2.7%
Handling and administration	2.50	0.35	2.1%
Total production cost	118.14	16.41	100%
Factory gross profit	18.66	2.59	13.6% of price
Factory price	136.80	19.00	—

Yarn 73.6%

Other production 26.4%

Gross margin formula

$$(136.80 - 118.14) \div 136.80 = 13.6\%$$

Why USD 15 fails

$$\text{USD } 15 \times 7.20 - 118.14 = -\text{RMB } 10.14$$

USD line items are rounded. The RMB calculation controls the model.

DO NOT REUSE ONE PRICE ACROSS FIBRES

Material and Programme Comparison

Programme	Known from source	Additional variables	Cost status
100% wool sweater	2/26Nm, 12GG, 350g, RMB 230/kg	5 colours, special wash, basic jersey	USD 16.41 cost / USD 19 price
Mohair knitwear	No mohair ratio or price in source	Blend ratio, shedding, brushing, halo, yarn minimum	To be re-costed
High-end wool yarn	No micron, origin or premium stated	Micron, traceability, RWS, dyeing, hand feel	To be confirmed
Cashmere or brushed cashmere	Not the case material	Fibre grade, brushing loss, pilling, shedding	To be re-costed
Wool blend	No blend formula stated	Fibre percentages, durability, target price	To be confirmed
B2B knitwear programme	500 pieces / five colours	Size ratio, labels, testing, Incoterm, delivery	Quote by specification

Buyer rule

A visually similar sweater is not a commercially identical product. Composition, finished weight, yarn count, gauge, colour split, washing and testing must all match before two quotations are comparable.

Keyword and scope note

Terms such as **mohair knitwear**, **premium wool yarn**, **European knitwear OEM** and **B2B knitwear materials** are relevant sourcing categories, but they are not substitutes for the confirmed pure wool case data.

FACTORY COSTING SCENARIO

Production Case Visual Module



Source article visual: wool yarn, finished sweater, factory machinery, trims and the USD 19 costing sheet. This is a costing illustration from the published article, not an independently verified customer documentary photograph.

Case output

- 500 finished sweaters
- Five colours
- 100 pieces per colour
- 189kg costed yarn
- USD 19 factory price

What is not claimed

- No named customer is identified.
- No delivery time is claimed.
- No third-party test result is claimed.
- No mohair composition is claimed.
- No universal market price is claimed.

BUYER READINESS CHECKLIST

European Buyer Delivery Readiness

The source article does not state a fixed European delivery lead time. Delivery readiness should therefore be evaluated through documented approvals rather than an invented schedule.

Product confirmation

- Fibre composition
- Yarn count and lot
- Finished weight
- Measurement tolerance
- Colour standard
- Approved washed sample

Quality confirmation

- Shrinkage method
- Pilling requirement
- Colour fastness
- Surface and linking checks
- Final inspection scope

Private label confirmation

- Neck and size labels
- Fibre and care label
- Hangtag and barcode
- Polybag and carton marks
- Language requirements

Commercial confirmation

- EXW, FOB or other Incoterm
- Named place or port
- Testing responsibility
- Third-party inspection cost
- Replacement responsibility

International reference: use the [ICC Incoterms 2020 rules](#) to define cost and risk allocation. A factory price, EXW price and FOB price are not automatically equivalent.

SPECIFICATION BEFORE QUOTATION

Request a Practical Knitwear Cost Review

For a useful quotation, send the product specification before asking for a target price.

Recommended input

- Tech pack or reference garment
- Target fibre composition and yarn direction
- Gauge, finished weight and stitch structure
- Order quantity and quantity per colour
- Washing, trims, packaging and testing requirements
- Target Incoterm and destination

Contact

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Sample policy: to be confirmed after specification, yarn, colour, gauge and finishing review. No fixed free-sample policy is stated in the source article.

A transparent quotation explains what is included, what remains variable and what must change when the target price changes.

YOUTRICOT

Premium Knitwear Development and Manufacturing

YouTricot supports international fashion brands with yarn selection, sample development, fine gauge knitwear, private label production, washing, finishing, quality control and export coordination.

Service scope

- Custom knitwear OEM
- Knitwear ODM development
- Private label knitwear
- Fine gauge wool sweaters
- Low MOQ planning
- Trims and packaging

Buyer markets

- European fashion brands
- Boutiques and wholesalers
- DTC labels
- Independent designers
- Importers and sourcing teams

<https://www.youtricot.com>

[Read the original cost analysis](#)

Disclaimer: This document is for industry education and commercial planning. It is not a binding quotation, certification guarantee, tax opinion or delivery commitment. Final price and terms require written confirmation.